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Interference detection and coarse parameter estimation using learned and inferred baseline information

Abstract

Improved techniques for estimating parameters of a jamming signal. An input signal is identified. This input signal is suspected of being a jammed composite signal. Attributes of a reference signal are determined. The reference signal is an expected signal that was expected to be received. A form fitting operation is performed in which the reference signal is formed fitted with the input signal. The reference signal is subtracted from the input signal to generate an isolated output signal. A suspected portion of the isolated output signal is identified. An estimated symbol rate and an estimated center frequency for the jamming signal are determined based on the suspected portion. The estimated symbol rate and the estimated center frequency are used to facilitate a subsequent mitigation operation of eliminating or reducing an impact of the jamming signal against the signal of interest.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) Numerous different devices can be equipped with an antenna system for transmitting and/or receiving radio frequency (“RF”) communications. These RF communications may be transmitted to, or received from, any number of different external targets, endpoints, wireless network nodes, or systems. As an example, RF communications can be sent and received by walkie-talkies, cell phones, vehicles, airplanes, rotary aircraft, ships, satellites, and so on.

(2) RF communications have advanced significantly in recent years. Now, more than ever before,

devices with RF capabilities are able to establish (in many cases even simultaneously) different RF communication links with external transmitters and receivers. Such advancements have substantially improved the quality of life. Because of the benefits provided by RF communications, more and more RF components (e.g., RF front-end components and RF back-end components) are being installed into electronic devices. With the proliferation of wireless RF communications, there is a substantial need to continuously improve such communications, especially in scenarios where signal interference may occur.

(3) The subject matter claimed herein is not limited to embodiments that solve any disadvantages or that operate only in environments such as those described above. Rather, this background is only provided to illustrate one exemplary technology area where some embodiments described herein may be practiced.

BRIEF SUMMARY

(4) Embodiments disclosed herein relate to systems, devices, and methods for inferring coarse information regarding aspects of an interfering or jamming signal to thereby lead to improved detection and parameter estimation. Such inferences can then be used to perform mitigation operations in order to eliminate or reduce the impact of a jamming signal.

(5) In some embodiments, an input signal is identified. This input signal is suspected of being a jammed composite signal comprising a combination of a signal of interest (SOI) and a jamming signal. Attributes of a reference signal are determined. These attributes include a center frequency of the reference signal and a symbol rate of the reference signal. The reference signal is an expected signal that was expected to be received in lieu of the input signal. A form fitting operation is performed in which the reference signal is formed fitted with the input signal to obtain a best fit alignment between the reference signal and the input signal. The embodiments subtract the reference signal from the input signal to generate an isolated output signal. A suspected portion of the isolated output signal is then identified, where the suspected portion is a portion where the jamming signal is likely to be occurring (e.g., the frequency range of the jamming signal). The embodiments determine a symbol rate of the suspected portion and a center frequency of the suspected portion. Additionally, the embodiments set the symbol rate of the suspected portion as an estimated symbol rate of the jamming signal and set the center frequency of the suspected portion as an estimated center frequency of the jamming signal. Furthermore, the embodiments use the estimated symbol rate of the jamming signal and the estimated center frequency of the jamming signal to facilitate a subsequent mitigation operation of eliminating or reducing an impact of the jamming signal against the SOI.

(6) In some embodiments, the process of subtracting the reference signal from the input signal includes determining an average relative power of the input signal. Based on the average relative power of the input signal, the process also includes determining that an estimated average relative power of the reference signal is a threshold amount below the average relative power of the input signal. The reference signal, including the estimated average relative power of the reference signal, is subtracted from the input signal, including the average relative power of the input signal, to generate the isolated output signal.

(7) This Summary is provided to introduce a selection of concepts in a simplified form that are further described below in the Detailed Description. This Summary is not intended to identify key features or essential features of the claimed subject matter, nor is it intended to be used as an aid in determining the scope of the claimed subject matter.

(8) Additional features and advantages will be set forth in the description which follows, and in part will be obvious from the description, or may be learned by the practice of the teachings herein. Features and advantages of the invention may be realized and obtained by means of the instruments and combinations particularly pointed out in the appended claims. Features of the present invention will become more fully apparent from the following description and appended claims, or may be learned by the practice of the invention as set forth hereinafter.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) In order to describe the manner in which the above-recited and other advantages and features can be obtained, a more particular description of the subject matter briefly described above will be rendered by reference to specific embodiments which are illustrated in the appended drawings. Understanding that these drawings depict only typical embodiments and are not therefore to be considered to be limiting in scope, embodiments will be described and explained with additional specificity and detail through the use of the accompanying drawings in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 illustrates an example of an electromagnetic wave that can be used to facilitate wireless communications between multiple devices.
- (3) FIG. 2 illustrates how a device, perhaps situated within an airplane, can communicate with a ground terminal and/or with satellites using electromagnetic waves.
- (4) FIG. 3 illustrates how handheld devices can also communicate wirelessly using electromagnetic waves.
- (5) FIG. 4 illustrates how one device can concurrently communicate with multiple other devices. Such a scenario can sometimes lead to signal interference.
- (6) FIG. 5 illustrates how the transmission and/or reception of multiple electromagnetic waves can lead to a scenario where signals interfere or jam with one another.
- (7) FIG. 6 illustrates a flowchart of an example method for identifying coarse parameters of a jamming signal.
- (8) FIG. 7 illustrates an example waveform depicting an input signal, which is a composite signal comprising a signal of interest (SOI) and a jamming or interfering signal.
- (9) FIG. 8 illustrates an example waveform depicting a reference signal, which is an expected signal that a device is expecting to receive as opposed to the input signal the device actually received.
- (10) FIG. 9 illustrates an example form fitting operation in which the reference signal is form fitted to the input signal.
- (11) FIG. 10 illustrates an example process for subtracting the reference signal from the input signal to generate the isolated output signal.
- (12) FIG. 11 illustrates an example operation in which the form fitted reference signal is subtracted from the input signal to produce an isolated output signal.
- (13) FIG. 12 illustrates an example graph illustrating the three different waveforms mentioned above, including the input signal, the reference signal, and the isolated output signal.
- (14) FIG. 13 illustrates how the isolated output signal includes a distinct hump portion, which is a suspected portion that is suspected of representing the jamming signal or of representing the frequency range where the jamming signal is occurring.
- (15) FIG. 14 illustrates an example process for identifying the roll off locations of a parabolic equation.
- (16) FIG. 15 illustrates how a form fitting algorithm can be used to map or generate a parabolic equation that is form fitted against the suspected portion of the isolated output signal.
- (17) FIG. 16 illustrates how a symbol rate and a center frequency can be determined for the distinct hump portion of the isolated output signal, where the symbol rate and the center frequency represent coarse parameters of the jamming signal.
- (18) FIG. 17 illustrates an example architecture in which coarse parameters of a jamming signal can be identified.
- (19) FIG. 18 illustrates a flowchart of an example method for performing a multi-stage iterative scheme to determine fine granularity attributes or parameters of a jamming signal and for reducing the influence of that jamming signal on a SOI.

- (20) FIG. 19 illustrates an architecture for performing the multi-stage iterative scheme.
- (21) FIG. 20 illustrates an architecture for a parameter estimator.
- (22) FIG. 21 illustrates a graph in which a filter is being applied to the input signal.
- (23) FIG. 22 illustrates an example graph of the filtered input signal.
- (24) FIG. 23 illustrates a graph showing the filtered input signal after that signal was run through a non-linear operator.
- (25) FIG. 24 shows the use of a narrow filter.
- (26) FIG. 25 shows the resulting waveform after the narrow filter has been executed.
- (27) FIG. 26 describes an example process for using a demod-remod circuit to cancel out the effects of a jamming signal from an input signal.
- (28) FIG. 27 shows an example architecture of a removal component.
- (29) FIG. 28 illustrates an example computer system configured to perform any of the disclosed operations.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (30) Embodiments disclosed herein relate to systems, devices, and methods for inferring coarse information regarding aspects of an interfering or jamming signal to thereby lead to improved detection and parameter estimation of a jamming signal. Such inferences can then be used to perform mitigation operations in order to eliminate or reduce the impact of the jamming signal.
- (31) In some embodiments, an input signal is identified. This input signal is suspected of being a jammed composite signal. Attributes of a reference signal are determined. These attributes include a center frequency and a symbol rate. The reference signal is an expected signal that was expected to be received. A form fitting operation is performed in which the reference signal is formed fitted with the input signal. The embodiments subtract the reference signal from the input signal to generate an isolated output signal. A suspected portion of the isolated output signal is then identified, where the suspected portion is a portion where the jamming signal is likely to be occurring (e.g., a frequency or frequency range at which the jamming signal is occurring). The embodiments determine an estimated symbol rate and an estimated center frequency for the jamming signal using the suspected portion. The embodiments use the estimated symbol rate and the estimated center frequency to facilitate a subsequent mitigation operation of eliminating or reducing an impact of the jamming signal against the signal of interest (SOI).
- (32) In some embodiments, the process of subtracting the reference signal from the input signal includes determining an average relative power of the input signal. Based on the average relative power of the input signal, the process also includes determining that an estimated average relative power of the reference signal is a threshold amount below the average relative power of the input signal. The reference signal, including the estimated average relative power of the reference signal, is subtracted from the input signal, including the average relative power of the input signal, to generate the isolated output signal.

Examples of Technical Benefits, Improvements, and Practical Applications

- (33) The following section outlines some example improvements and practical applications provided by the disclosed embodiments. It will be appreciated, however, that these are just examples only and that the embodiments are not limited to only these improvements.
- (34) The disclosed embodiments bring about numerous real and practical improvements to the technical field. Generally, the disclosed embodiments use both inferred and learned information to uncover aspects of an interfering or jamming signal. That inferred information can then be used to improve both the detection and estimation of the parameters for that interfering signal. By determining the attributes of the interfering signal, the embodiments can then beneficially facilitate subsequent mitigation operations in an attempt to remove, eliminate, mitigate or at least reduce the impact of the interfering signal on a signal of interest (SOI). In this regard, the embodiments improve RF communications and improve how devices communicate with one another. In doing so, the embodiments also improve the efficiency of the electronic devices because retransmissions

(e.g., which occur because of jamming) can be avoided as a result of providing an initially clear and coherent signal (e.g., by reducing the effects of the jamming signal).

(35) The disclosed embodiments also beneficially input the spectra of a combination of interferers and signal-of-interests (SOI) to thereby minimize the effect of the jamming signals on the SOI signals using learned and inferred information about the SOI. The embodiments are also able to detect the largest interferers and to return approximate values for the interferer's symbol rates, center frequencies, and perhaps even relative powers. By performing the disclosed operations, the embodiments beneficially enable the identification and classification of interference signals. The embodiments also facilitate subsequent determinations of fine or granular estimation of the interference parameters. Such information (i.e. the parameters) can then be used for active cancellation of interferers.

(36) Yet another benefit includes removing the effects of a high-powered jamming signal. That is, the disclosed embodiments can operate even when a high-powered jamming signal is present in the input signal. Indeed, the disclosed embodiments are able to reduce the effects of a high-powered jamming signal even to the extent of 25 dB or more.

(37) The embodiments provide additional benefits as well. For instance, the disclosed embodiments are able to use multiple signal processing techniques to achieve classification and very fine or granular parameter estimation of an unknown interferer. The parameter estimation error is sufficient to enable low-loop-bandwidth signal demodulation. The disclosed operations or algorithms also achieve high probabilities of acquisition at low interference-power-to-signal-power (J/S) ratios and low acquisition times and further enables low SWaP (size, weight, and price) requirements. Additionally, the disclosed embodiments beneficially classify signals and finely estimate signal parameters such that an interfere can be removed through demodulation, remodulation, and subtraction (e.g., active cancellation). Accordingly, these and numerous other benefits will now be described throughout the remaining portions of this disclosure.

RF Communications

(38) To establish an RF communication link, an electronic device sends or receives an electromagnetic wave, such as a narrowband or wideband electromagnetic wave **100** illustrated in FIG. **1**, to a transmitter/receiver. Electromagnetic wave **100** includes an electric field **105** and a magnetic field **110**. Electromagnetic wave **100** may be launched by an antenna, and it may also be intercepted, or rather received by, the antenna.

(39) FIG. **2** shows how electromagnetic waves can be used to facilitate communications between multiple different devices. For example, FIG. **2** shows a plane **200** that includes an antenna **205**. The plane **200** is using the antenna **205** to communicate with a ground terminal **210**, as shown by the air-to-ground connectivity **215**. Additionally, the plane **200** is using an antenna **220** to communicate with a satellite **225**, as shown by satellite connectivity **230**.

(40) FIG. **3** shows another scenario in which RF communications occur via electromagnetic waves. Here, the RF communications are occurring between handheld devices, such as the walkie-talkies **300** and **305**. Accordingly, one will appreciate how the disclosed embodiments can improve any type of RF communications, including communications between large scale devices and communications between small scale devices, or any combination of large and small scale devices.

(41) FIG. **4** shows a scenario in which a satellite **400** is concurrently or simultaneously communicating with multiple different devices. Of course, satellites are not the only type of device that can communicate simultaneously with other devices. As such, these figures are used for example purposes only.

(42) Specifically, a satellite **400**, an airplane **405**, a ground terminal **410**, and a helicopter **415** are all communicating with one another. As indicated above, it may be the case that all of these communications are happening simultaneously with one another. In some cases, an ad hoc mesh network is being used. In some cases, a CDMA mesh network is being used. Often, it is the case that each transmission uses a different frequency in order to communicate. Sometimes, however,

multiple transmissions may use (i) the same frequency, (ii) an overlapping frequency range, and/or (iii) frequencies that are sufficiently near one another such that crosstalk or leakage occurs, thereby resulting in a scenario where the transmissions interfere with one another. In some cases, the interference may be innocent (e.g., an operator perhaps accidentally used the wrong frequency and interfered with another signal) while in other cases the interference may be intentional, such as a malicious use of jammer. FIG. 5 provides more detail.

(43) FIG. 5 shows a signal of interest **500** and a jamming signal **505**. The signal of interest **500** represents a signal, RF communication, or electromagnetic wave that is destined for an endpoint terminal using a particular frequency. The jamming signal **505** represents another signal that is using the same frequency, the same frequency range, or a frequency that is sufficiently near the frequency of the signal of interest **500** such that the jamming signal **505** interferes with the signal of interest **500**. The jamming signal **505** can be a benign signal or a malign signal, as discussed above.

(44) Because the frequencies of the signal of interest **500** and the jamming signal **505** are interfering with one another, the two (or potentially more than two) signals constructively or destructively combine with one another, resulting in a jammed composite signal **510**. That is, the jammed composite signal **510** is a combination of the signal of interest **500** and the jamming signal **505**. In effect, the jamming signal **505** has jammed or interfered with the signal of interest **500**. If a receiving device were to receive the jammed composite signal **510** and not perform any extraction or mitigation operations to remove the jamming signal **505** component from the jammed composite signal **510**, the receiving device would not be able to properly interpret the signal of interest **500**. What is needed, therefore, is an improved technique for performing compensation or mitigation when a signal is interfered by at least one other signal.

Identifying Coarse Parameters of an Interfering Signal

(45) The following discussion now refers to a number of methods and method acts that may be performed. Although the method acts may be discussed in a certain order or illustrated in a flow chart as occurring in a particular order, no particular ordering is required unless specifically stated, or required because an act is dependent on another act being completed prior to the act being performed.

(46) Attention will now be directed to FIG. 6, which illustrates a flowchart of an example method **600** for inferring coarse information regarding aspects of an interfering signal to thereby lead to improved detection and parameter estimation of that interfering signal. The discussion regarding method **600** will be accompanied by a discussion of FIGS. 7 to 17.

(47) Initially, method **600** is shown as including an act (act **605**) of identifying an input signal that is suspected of being a jammed composite signal comprising a combination of a signal of interest (SOI) and a jamming signal. With reference to FIG. 5, the input signal may be the jammed composite signal **510**, the SOI may be the signal of interest **500**, and the jamming signal may be the jamming signal **505**.

(48) Turning briefly to FIG. 7, this figure illustrates a graph of a waveform depicting an example input signal **700**, which can be received by any of the devices mentioned thus far and which is representative of the input signal mentioned in act **605**. The graph has Power (dBMaxOutput) as the y-axis and Frequency Relative to SOI (MHz) as the x-axis. The waveform of the input signal **700** is shown for example purposes only and should not be construed as binding in any manner. Accordingly, the input signal **700** is a signal that is suspected of being a jammed composite signal, which includes a combination of a signal of interest (SOI) (e.g., signal of interest **500** from FIG. 5) and a jamming signal (e.g., jamming signal **505**).

(49) Returning to FIG. 6, method **600** includes an act (act **610**) of determining attributes of a reference signal. Notably, prior to receiving the input signal mentioned earlier, two communicating devices can establish a link with one another. With the establishment of the link, each device has information regarding attributes or characteristics of the signal that will subsequently be received.

The attributes include at least a center frequency of the reference signal and a symbol rate of the reference signal. The reference signal is an expected signal that was expected to be received in lieu of the input signal. FIG. 8 shows an example of a reference signal.

(50) FIG. 8 shows a graph of an example waveform in the form of a reference signal **800** that has particular attributes **805**. Whereas the input signal **700** of FIG. 7 represents an actual signal that is received at a device, the reference signal **800** represents a signal that is expected to be received at the device.

(51) Stated differently, the waveform labeled reference signal **800** is the inferred and learned spectrum of an SOI. The shape of that spectrum is inferred and learned from 1) known parameters, 2) assumed parameters, and/or 3) run-time experience. Any applied scaling is learned through optimization.

(52) To further clarify, as discussed before, it is often the case that a received signal has been subject to interference. The difference in visual form and other characteristics between the input signal **700** and the reference signal **800** indicates that the input signal **700** has been interfered with in some manner. Stated differently, the input signal **700** is representative of the jammed composite signal **510** from FIG. 5, and the reference signal **800** is representative of the signal of interest **500** of FIG. 5. By knowing the attributes **805**, it is possible (by following the techniques disclosed herein) to obtain a coarse estimation of the parameters of the jamming signal that is jamming the input signal **700** (i.e. to determine the parameters of the jamming signal **505** from FIG. 5).

(53) During the initial link between the two communicating devices, the attributes **805** of the reference signal **800** are either transmitted or derived. Accordingly, the attributes of the reference signal are determined prior in time to a time when the input signal is received. The attributes **805** include, but might not be limited to, a center frequency **810** of the reference signal **800**, a symbol rate **815** of the reference signal **800**, a signal type **820** (or data structure or modulation type) of the reference signal **800** (e.g., a tone signal, a BPSK signal, a QPSK signal, a 8PSK signal, an offset QPSK, a CDMA (code-division multiple access), a 16 QAM, etc.), and an alpha value **825** of the reference signal **800**. The alpha value **825** represents how fast the waveform rolls off. That is, the alpha value **825** represents how steep the curve is and how narrow the waveform is, as shown by waveform narrowness **830**. Accordingly, the embodiments are able to determine the attributes **805** of the reference signal **800**.

(54) Returning to FIG. 6, method **600** includes an act (act **615**) of performing a form fitting operation in which the reference signal is form fitted with the input signal to obtain a best fit alignment between the reference signal and the input signal. FIG. 9 is illustrative.

(55) In particular, FIG. 9 shows an input signal **905**, which is representative of the input signal **700** from FIG. 7, and a reference signal **910**, which is representative of the reference signal **800** of FIG. 8. The form fitting operation **900** includes aligning (e.g., as shown by form fit **915**) the reference signal **910** with the input signal **905** to find a best fit alignment **920** between those two waveforms.

(56) To illustrate, FIG. 9 shows how the reference signal **910** can be moved left or right and/or up and down in the graph in order to find the best fit alignment between itself and the input signal **905**. In the scenario shown in FIG. 9, the best fit alignment **920** between the reference signal **910** and the input signal **905** shows that the reference signal **910** fits best on the left-hand side of the input signal **905**.

(57) In some cases, the form fitting operations are performed by attempting to match or align as many points along the waveform of the reference signal **910** with as many points along the waveform of the input signal **905**. Optionally, instead of a direct match or alignment in which one point is directly on top of another point, alignment can occur if one point is within a threshold value of another point. For example, in the context of FIG. 9, one point on the reference signal **910** may be considered to be aligned with a point on the input signal **905** if the reference signal point is within a threshold frequency value (e.g., perhaps 1 Hz, 2 Hz, 10 Hz, 100 Hz, 1,000 Hz, etc.) of the input signal value. Any threshold value may be used.

(58) The alignment process may entail attempting to “align” a maximum number or, alternatively, a minimum threshold number of reference signal points with corresponding input signal points. Notice, in FIG. 9, the entirety of the reference signal **910** (even when at the location of the best fit alignment **920**) does not fully align with the input signal **905**. Instead, that alignment was selected because a maximum number of points (or at least a threshold number) on the reference signal **910** align with corresponding points on the input signal **905**. Therefore, complete alignment or even a majority of alignment might not occur. In some cases, only a fractional alignment might occur, such as perhaps a 1% alignment, 2%, 3%, 4%, 5%, 10%, 15%, 20%, 25%, 30%, 35%, 40%, 45%, or more than 50% (e.g., 100%), or any value therebetween.

(59) Accordingly, in some embodiments, performing the form fitting operation in which the reference signal is form fitted with the input signal includes aligning a threshold number of points of a waveform representative of the reference signal with a corresponding number of points of a waveform representative of the input signal. In some embodiments a level of overlap between the reference signal and the input signal is required to meet or satisfy an overlap requirement (e.g., anywhere between 1% overlap and 100% overlap). To overlap, points from the two waveforms do not necessarily or strictly need to be on top of one another; rather, the points can be within a threshold distance or frequency range relative to one another.

(60) Some embodiments perform alignment by selecting a set of one or more points on the reference signal **910** and then aligning that set of one or more points with corresponding points on the input signal **905**. The remaining points in the reference signal **910** can optionally be disregarded with regard to the alignment process. Accordingly, in some embodiments, performing the form fitting operation in which the reference signal is form fitted with the input signal includes selecting at least a set of points along a waveform representative of the reference signal and aligning the set of points with corresponding points of a waveform representative of the input signal. In this regard, alignment may occur by considering or aligning at least a set or subset of points in the reference signal **910** with the input signal **905**.

(61) In some embodiments, the alignment may occur by smoothing out the input signal **905** (e.g., to remove localized peaks and valleys) and then computing the waveform's tangent. The tangent of the reference signal **910** can also be determined. The alignment process can then be performed by matching or aligning areas along the curves where the two tangent values match one another or are within a threshold value of one another. In some cases, the smoothing operation might not be performed, but the tangent determination is performed.

(62) Accordingly, the embodiments are able to perform a form fitting operation **900** in which the reference signal **910** is form fitted with the input signal **905** to obtain a best fit alignment **920** between the reference signal **910** and the input signal **905**.

(63) Returning to FIG. 6, after a best fit alignment is determined between the reference signal and the input signal, there is an act (act **620**) of subtracting the reference signal from the input signal to generate an isolated output signal. FIGS. 10 and 11 are illustrative.

(64) Specifically, FIG. 10 shows a process **1000** of the subtraction technique mentioned above. Initially, the process **1000** includes an act (act **1005**) of determining an average relative power of the input signal.

(65) Turning briefly to FIG. 11, this figure shows an input signal **1100** and a reference signal **1105**, both of which are representative of their corresponding signals mentioned earlier. To facilitate the subtraction process, the embodiments determine an average relative power **1110** of the input signal.

(66) Based on the average relative power **1110** of the input signal **1100**, the process **1000** of FIG. 10 includes an act (act **1010**) of determining that an estimated average relative power of the reference signal is a threshold amount below the average relative power of the input signal. To illustrate, FIG. 11 shows how the estimated average relative power **1115** of the reference signal **1105** is a threshold **1120** amount below the average relative power **1110** of the input signal **1100**.

(67) The threshold **1120** amount is often between about 3 dB and 5 dB. Consequently, the estimated

average relative power **1115** of the reference signal **1105** is typically between about 3 dB to 5 dB below the average relative power **1110** of the input signal **1100**. In some cases, the threshold is between about 2 dB and about 6 dB. It may be the case, however, that the range is larger, such as perhaps between about 1 dB and about 10 dB.

(68) The process **1000** of FIG. **10** then includes an act (act **1015**) of subtracting the reference signal (including its estimated average relative power) from the input signal (including its average relative power). In FIG. **11**, the subtract **1125** is reflective of act **1015**. The result of the subtract **1125** process is the isolated output signal **1130**, which was also introduced in method act **620** of FIG. **6**.

(69) By way of additional clarification, as seen by the input signal **1100**, the interferer is scarcely seen in that spectral input. However, the isolated output signal **1130** not only clearly reveals the interferer signal, but also reveals the support and location of the interferer, thereby enabling solid interference bandwidth and center-frequency coarse estimation. These coarse estimates are beneficial for down-stream interference classification and fine parameter estimation. Accordingly, the disclosed operations significantly improve the ability and probability of detecting interference signals and even reduces parameter estimation bias in the presence of SOI(s).

(70) FIG. **12** shows a graph depicting the three different waveforms. Specifically, FIG. **12** shows an input signal **1200**, a reference signal **1205**, and an isolated output signal **1210**. These three waveforms are representative of the three waveforms illustrated in FIG. **11** and the other figures as well.

(71) Returning to FIG. **6**, method **600** includes an act (act **625**) of identifying a suspected portion of the isolated output signal where the jamming signal is likely to be occurring. FIG. **13** is illustrative.

(72) FIG. **13** shows an isolated output signal **1300**, which is representative of the isolated output signals mentioned thus far. Notice, this waveform has a distinct hump or peak where the waveform increases or changes significantly from the initial trend or trajectory of the waveform. That is, the dotted arrow labeled initial trajectory **1305** shows how the waveform generally follows a particular path or trajectory. Then, at the divergence point **1310**, the waveform follows an entirely different path or trajectory, as shown by new trajectory **1315**. The area of the waveform surrounded by the dotted lines emphasizes a so-called distinct hump **1320**. The embodiments are able to analyze waveforms to identify divergence points (i.e. areas where the tangent of the line changes a threshold amount such that a distinct hump is formed) in order to identify humps, or so-called suspected portions, such as suspected portion **1325**. The suspected portion **1325** is the area in the waveform that is suspected of being an area or frequency range where the jamming signal is likely to be occurring. Accordingly, the process of identifying the suspected portion of the isolated output signal where the jamming signal is likely to be occurring can be performed by identifying a distinct hump in the isolated output signal and/or by identifying a hump in a corresponding parabolic function that aligns with the isolated output signal.

(73) In some embodiments, a machine learning (ML) algorithm is used to identify trajectory changes in a waveform, or rather, to identify distinct humps that are suspected of corresponding to a jamming signal. Any type of ML algorithm, model, machine learning, or neural network may be used to identify distinct humps that may constitute a suspect or suspected portion. As used herein, reference to “machine learning” or to a ML model or to a “neural network” may include any type of machine learning algorithm or device, neural network (e.g., convolutional neural network(s), multilayer neural network(s), recursive neural network(s), deep neural network(s), dynamic neural network(s), etc.), decision tree model(s) (e.g., decision trees, random forests, and gradient boosted trees), linear regression model(s) or logistic regression model(s), support vector machine(s) (“SVM”), artificial intelligence device(s), or any other type of intelligent computing system. Any amount of training data may be used (and perhaps later refined) to train the machine learning algorithm to dynamically perform the disclosed operations. Accordingly, a ML algorithm can be used to identify the suspected portion of the isolated output signal, where the ML algorithm is implemented using any of the techniques described above.

(74) Returning to FIG. 6, method **600** then includes an act (act **630**) of determining a symbol rate of the suspected portion and a center frequency of the suspected portion. FIGS. **14**, **15**, and **16** are illustrative.

(75) Specifically, FIG. **14** illustrates an example process **1400** that may be performed in order to determine the symbol rate and center frequency of the suspected portion, as recited in act **630** of method **600**. Initially, process **1400** includes an act (act **1405**) of performing a form fitting operation in which a parabolic equation is form fitted to the suspected portion of the isolated output signal. FIG. **15** shows such a process.

(76) In particular, FIG. **15** shows the use of a form fitting algorithm **1500** that uses a parabolic equation **1505** (or perhaps some other type of equation) in order to generate a form fit line **1510** that tracks or generally matches at least the area of the isolated output signal corresponding to the suspected portion.

(77) In FIG. **14**, the process **1400** then includes an act (**1410**) of identifying a localized peak or valley of the parabolic equation, or rather of the form fitted line. FIG. **16** shows an example.

(78) FIG. **16** shows an isolated output signal **1600** and a form fit line **1605**, which are representative of the corresponding features mentioned earlier. A localized peak **1610** is also identified for the form fit line **1605**.

(79) Returning to FIG. **14**, the process **1400** also includes an act (act **1415**) of identifying a first roll off of a first side of the parabolic equation (or form fit line) and a second roll off of a second side of the parabolic equation. In FIG. **16**, the embodiments identified the roll off **1615** and the roll off **1620**. In some embodiments, the roll offs (e.g., roll off **1615** and **1620**) are selected to be about 3 dB less than the localized peak **1610** on each side of the peak. In some embodiments, the roll offs are selected to be a threshold amount less than the localized peak **1610**, where the threshold amount can be anywhere including and between about 1 dB and about 5 dB.

(80) With the roll offs **1615** and **1620** now known, the embodiments can determine a symbol rate **1625**, which is the frequency range that exists between the roll offs **1615** and **1620**. To clarify, the symbol rate of the suspected portion is determined based on the first roll off **1615** and the second roll off **1620**, or rather, based on the difference between those two values. In this example scenario, the roll off **1615** is at about 1 MHz, and the roll off **1620** is at about 8 MHz. The symbol rate **1625** is then computed as the difference between those two values, resulting in a symbol rate **1625** of about 7 MHz. Additionally, the center frequency **1630** is selected as the center frequency value between the two roll offs **1615** and **1620**. In this example case, the center frequency **1630** is about 5 MHz, or slightly below. That is, the center frequency of the suspected portion is determined based on a center frequency value of the parabolic equation between the first roll off **1615** and the second roll off **1620**.

(81) The roll offs **1615** and **1620** and the center frequency **1630** are then selected to operate as the symbol rate and the center frequency of the suspected portion, as described in method act **630** in FIG. **6**. These values constitute coarse estimates of what the actual or true symbol rate and center frequency are likely to be for the actual jamming symbol. Generally, the estimated symbol rate (which is that of the jamming symbol) is within a first range between about 500 kilohertz and about 700 KHz of an actual symbol rate of the jamming signal. Similarly, the estimated center frequency is within a second range between about 500 KHz and about 700 KHz of an actual center frequency of the jamming signal. In some cases, the estimated center frequency is within a range between about 400 KHz and about 800 KHz of an actual center frequency of the jamming signal (i.e. the carrier frequency).

(82) Returning to FIG. **6**, method **600** then includes an act (act **635**) of setting the symbol rate of the suspected portion as an estimated symbol rate of the jamming signal and setting the center frequency of the suspected portion as an estimated center frequency of the jamming signal. Act **640** then involves using the estimated symbol rate of the jamming signal and the estimated center frequency of the jamming signal to facilitate a subsequent mitigation operation of eliminating or

reducing an impact of the jamming signal against the SOI. An example of the mitigation operation includes, but is not limited to, removing the effects of the jamming signal from the input signal in order to accurately reproduce or identify the SOI. Such removal can later occur via use of a demod-remod circuit, which will be discussed in more detail later.

(83) FIG. 17 illustrates an example architecture **1700** that may be used to facilitate the disclosed operations. Here, the architecture **1700** is shown as receiving an input signal **1705**, which is representative of the input signals mentioned thus far. The input signal **1705** is fed as input into an analysis engine **1710** that performs the acts described in method **600**. In some implementations, the analysis engine **1710** is or includes a ML algorithm **1715** configured to perform the disclosed operations. As a result of performing the operations described in method **600**, the analysis engine **1710** generates a coarse estimate of a jamming signal **1720**. This coarse estimate includes an estimated center frequency **1725** and an estimated symbol rate **1730**. Other parameters of the jamming signal may also be determined. Based on at least the estimated center frequency **1725** and the estimated symbol rate **1730**, the analysis engine **1710** can perform one or more mitigation operations, as shown by mitigation operation **1735**, in order to remove, eliminate, reduce, or dampen the effects of the jamming signal on the SOI.

(84) Accordingly, the disclosed embodiments are beneficially configured to infer coarse information regarding aspects of an interfering signal to thereby lead to improved detection and parameter estimation of a jamming signal. By deriving these coarse parameters, the embodiments are better able to respond to scenarios where a jamming signal is interfering with a SOI.

Multi-Stage Iterative Scheme to Determine Fine Granularity Estimates of Jamming Signal Parameters

(85) Up to this point, the disclosure has focused on a technique for determining a coarse estimate of a jamming signal's parameters. Now, the disclosure will focus on a multi-stage iterative scheme or process for determining fine granularity estimates of parameters of an interfering signal and for using the fine granularity estimate to reduce or eliminate an impact of the interfering signal against the SOI. Generally, the disclosed embodiments use a Fast Fourier Transform (FFT) along with multiple signal processing techniques to enable a staged and distributed approach to incrementally reduce the estimation error and to achieve low hardware utilization (e.g., FPGA, processor, etc.). The low SWaP approach allows the disclosed techniques to be co-hosted along with other high-resource-utilization processing, such as complex waveforms.

(86) Beneficially, the embodiments do not rely on a large FFT to produce the fine resolution required. Instead, the embodiments use (i) a moderately sized FFT, (ii) non-linear functions (e.g., to produce narrow-band tones), (iii) a difference technique (e.g., to identify the tones), and (iv) multi-rate processing and a bin interpolation techniques (e.g., to finely resolve the tones and to produce the low estimation errors required for narrow-loop-bandwidth pull in). At a high level, the disclosed techniques start with an unknown signal (e.g., the input signal) and achieve detection, classification, and fine parameter estimation in substantially real time. This process is referred to as signal acquisition and occurs in a short period of time (e.g., approximately one second or less). Furthermore, this approach assures that the latency (i.e. the time between signal input and signal output) is not increased by signal acquisition, thus providing latency in the tens of microseconds.

(87) Beneficially, the carrier frequency estimation error is approximately 0.000025% of the actual carrier frequency. The symbol rate estimation error is about 0.04% of the actual symbol rate. Previous known approaches for producing such low estimation errors either resulted in very high gate counts or very long acquisition times. The disclosed approach produces low estimation errors with methods that enable distributed processing across hardware and software and achieve low acquisition times and low complexity.

(88) With that background, attention will now be directed to FIG. 18, which illustrates a flowchart of an example method **1800** for providing the multi-stage approach discussed above. Initially, method **1800** includes an act (act **1805**) of identifying an input signal that is suspected of being a

jammed composite signal comprising a combination of a signal of interest (SOI) and a jamming signal. Act **1805** is similar to act **605** of method **600**.

(89) Method **1800** also includes an act (act **1810**) of determining a first set of estimation parameters that provide a coarse granularity estimate of a center frequency of the jamming signal and of a symbol rate of the jamming signal. Determining the first set of estimation parameters can be performed by following the steps outlined in method **600**. By following the processes outlined in method **600**, the embodiments are able to generate a coarse granularity estimate of the center frequency and symbol rate of the jamming signal. Accordingly, method **600** provides details on how to accomplish act **1810**.

(90) Method **1800** then includes an act (act **1815**) of refining the first set of estimation parameters to generate a second set of estimation parameters. This second set provides a medium granularity estimate of the center frequency and the symbol rate of the jamming frequency. Notably, the medium granularity estimate of the center frequency and the symbol rate is relatively closer to actual values of the center frequency and the symbol rate than a relative closeness provided by the coarse granularity estimate of the center frequency and the symbol rate. For instance, whereas the coarse granularity estimate for the symbol rate might be within about 700 KHz of the actual symbol rate, the medium granularity estimate will be within about 40 KHz of the actual symbol rate. FIGS. **19** through **25** provide additional details on this refining process.

(91) FIG. **19** shows an example architecture **1900**. Initially, a set of coarse granularity parameters **1905**, which are representative of the coarse granularity estimates described in act **1810**, are provided as input to a parameter estimator **1910**. The input signal **1915**, which is representative of the input signals mentioned throughout this disclosure, is also provided as input to the parameter estimator **1910**. As will be discussed in more detail shortly, the parameter estimator **1910** is able to generate a set of medium granularity parameters **1920**, which are representative of the medium granularity estimate mentioned in act **1815**. FIG. **20** provides detail on how the parameter estimator **1910** operates.

(92) FIG. **20** shows a parameter estimator **2000**. Initially, the coarse granularity parameters **2005**, which are representative of the coarse granularity parameters **1905** of FIG. **19**, are received as input to a selector **2010** switch, which can select which input to use. Notably, the embodiments are configured to use the parameter estimator **2000** at least twice, so the selector **2010** is provided to determine or select which input is fed into the estimator during each usage.

(93) Whichever parameters are selected using the selector **2010** are now referred to as parameters **2015**. These parameters **2015** are fed as input into a wide filter **2020**, which is a type of down-sampling low-pass filter. The wide filter **2020** uses the parameters **2015** to filter the input signal **2025**. FIG. **21** provides additional details.

(94) FIG. **21** shows the input signal and a filter **2105**, which is representative of the wide filter **2020**. The filter **2105** is shown as having a filter width **2110**. The filter width **2110** is selected to be the value of the coarse estimate of the jamming signal's symbol rate plus a wide buffer amount **2115**. In some instance, the wide buffer amount **2115** is selected to be 5%, 10%, 15%, 20%, or even 25% larger than the coarse estimate of the symbol rate. In some cases, the wide buffer amount **2115** is selected to be larger than 25%. In any event, the filter **2105** is centered at the coarse estimate of the center frequency of the jamming signal and operates to filter the input signal **2100**. FIG. **22** shows the resulting filtered signal **2200**.

(95) Returning to FIG. **20**, the filtered signal **2200** from FIG. **22** is then fed as input into a detector circuit **2030**. The detector circuit **2030** includes a non-linear operator **2035** that operates on the filtered signal. The non-linear operator **2035** is one of an x^4 operator, an x^2 operator, or a conjugate multiplier operator. By running the filtered signal through the non-linear operators, the embodiments are able to detect the modulation type **2035A** of the input signal. The detected modulation type **2035A** is also referred to as the data structure **2035B** of the signal (i.e. the data structure of the input signal and jamming signal can be

determined). The modulation type **2035A** can be a BPSK type, a QPSK type, an offset QPSK, an 8PSK type, a tone type, a 16 QAM type, or even a CDMA type.

(96) To further clarify, a BPSK can be run through the $x\{\text{circumflex over ()}\}^2$ operator, the $x\{\text{circumflex over ()}\}^4$ operator, and the conjugate multiplier. The embodiments then analyze the resulting waveform to attempt to identify tones in the signal. The identification of tones enables identification of the modulation type of the signal. A QPSK, a 8PSK, and a tone signal (or any other type of modulated signal) can all also be run through the various different non-linear operators. Identification of tones in the resulting waveform enables identification of the modulation type. FIG. 23 is illustrative.

(97) FIG. 23 shows the result of the detector circuit **2300**. The result illustrates a waveform **2305** that was run through the $x\{\text{circumflex over ()}\}^4$ non-linear operator. In this case, the filtered signal **2200** from FIG. 22 is a QPSK signal and was run through the $x\{\text{circumflex over ()}\}^4$ non-linear operator. The waveform **2305** is the result of the $x\{\text{circumflex over ()}\}^4$ operation. In this example case, the waveform **2305** includes a tone **2310**, a tone **2315**, and a tone **2320**. Accordingly, the waveform **2305** is the output of the detector circuit **2030** in FIG. 20.

(98) FIG. 20 then shows how the output of the detector circuit **2030** (i.e. the waveform **2305**) is then fed as input into a narrow filter **2040**, which may be a low pass down-sampling filter. FIG. 24 is illustrative.

(99) FIG. 24 shows a waveform **2400**, which is representative of the waveform **2305** from FIG. 23. The filter **2405** is representative of the narrow filter **2040**. The filter **2405** is shown as having a filter width **2410**, which is based on the location of the tone **2310** from FIG. 23 plus a narrow buffer amount **2415**. The narrow buffer amount **2415** can be 5%, 10%, 15%, 20%, 25%, or more than 25% the width of the tone **2310**. FIG. 25 shows the resulting filtered waveform **2500**, with dashed lines representing the determined symbol rate. The central tone is generally representative of the jamming signal's carrier frequency **2505** and the width between the outer tones (i.e. the dashed lines) is generally representative of the jamming signal's symbol rate **2510**.

(100) In some cases, the symbol rate **2510** can be determined by identifying the tones that are produced as a result of using the operators described above (e.g., $x\{\text{circumflex over ()}\}^2$ operator, $x\{\text{circumflex over ()}\}^4$ operator, $x\{\text{circumflex over ()}\}^8$ operator, etc.). Often, the symbol rate **2510** can be determined using a delay complex multiplier (e.g., a conjugate multiplier). For example, the signal can be delayed and then complexed multiplied. Performing such operations results in a signal with a central peak and perhaps multiple spikes on each side of the central peak. The symbol rate is then determined by analyzing the location of those side spikes or peaks. For example, the tones **2315** and **2320** from FIG. 23 can be considered as side peaks. Typically, the signal is symmetric. Based on that understanding, it is beneficial to fold the signal in half (e.g., at a vertical folding line) and then add the parts together. By adding the halves together, the spikes are then caused to grow to be twice their previous size. Data located in between the spikes can then be considered as noise and irrelevant data. The location of the spikes is then selected to be the symbol rate. In FIG. 25, the symbol rate **2510** is shown as being the width between the two side spikes that are dashed.

(101) Returning to FIG. 20, the filtered waveform **2500** from FIG. 25 is then fed as input into an FFT **2045**, which converts the waveform into the frequency domain. An averaging function **2050** is then applied to the frequency domain waveform in order to smooth out the waveform. That waveform is analyzed to identify the jamming signal's center or carrier frequency as well as the symbol rate, which are then selected to be the parameters **2055**.

(102) This first pass through the parameter estimator **2000** enables the embodiments to generate a set of medium granularity parameters **2060**, which are closer or more accurate to the true values of the jamming signal's center frequency and symbol rate than that of the coarse granularity parameters **2005**.

(103) Returning to FIG. 18, method **1800** includes an act (act **1820**) of refining the second set of

estimation parameters to generate a third set of estimation parameters. This third set of estimation parameters provides a fine granularity estimate of the center frequency and the symbol rate of the jamming frequency. This third set can further include a modulation type of the jamming signal. The fine granularity estimate of the center frequency and the symbol rate is relatively closer to the actual values of the center frequency and the symbol rate than a relative closeness provided by the medium granularity estimate of the center frequency and the symbol rate. For instance, the fine granularity estimate of the symbol rate might be within about 500 Hz of the actual symbol rate. FIG. 19 provides additional details.

(104) Specifically, FIG. 19 shows how the medium granularity parameters **1920** are generated via a first pass-through through the parameter estimator **1910**. The medium granularity parameters **1920** are then fed as input to the parameter estimator **1925**, which is the same as or is an instance of the parameter estimator **1910**. The output of the parameter estimator **1925** is the fine granularity parameters **1930**. FIG. 20 provides more detail.

(105) Specifically, the medium granularity parameters **2060** are now available as input to the selector **2010**. Whereas in the first run-through of the parameter estimator **2000**, the coarse granularity parameters **2005** were selected by the selector **2010** to serve as the parameters **2015**, now on this second pass-through, the selector **2010** selects the medium granularity parameters **2060** to operate as the parameters **2015**. The same operations that were discussed earlier are performed again. Now, however, the wide buffer amount (e.g., wide buffer amount **2115**) and the narrow buffer amount (e.g., narrow buffer amount **2415**) are both selected to be smaller values than what were previously used and are selected based on the medium granularity parameters **2060**.

(106) After cycling or passing through the parameter estimator **2000** the second time, the embodiments determine whether the 2.sup.nd pass has occurred. If so, then the fine granularity parameters **2065** have been generated. FIG. 19 shows that the fine granularity parameters **1930** are then fed as input into a removal component **1935** to produce the SOI **1940**. Further details on these operations will be provided momentarily.

(107) Accordingly, the process of refining the first set of estimation parameters to generate the second set of estimation parameters includes using the first set of estimation parameters to apply a wide filter to the input signal to generate a first filtered signal. A width of the wide filter is set to a value of the coarse granularity estimate of the symbol rate of the jamming signal plus a wide buffer amount. The wide filter is centered at the coarse granularity estimate of the center frequency of the jamming signal and filters signal content beyond the coarse granularity estimate of the symbol rate plus the wide buffer amount. A signal type of the first filtered input is one of a tone signal, a BPSK signal, a QPSK signal, an offset QPSK, a 8PSK signal, a 16 QAM signal, or even a CDMA signal.

(108) The process also includes applying a non-linear operator to the first filtered signal to identify one or more tones in a resulting modified signal. A narrow filter is applied to the modified signal to generate a second filtered signal. A width of the narrow filter is set to a value of the coarse granularity estimate of the symbol rate of the jamming signal plus a narrow buffer amount. The narrow filter is centered at the coarse granularity estimate of the center frequency of the jamming signal. The process also includes applying a Fast Fourier Transform (FFT) to the second filtered signal to generate a frequency-domain signal. The process also includes applying an averaging function to the frequency-domain signal to smooth out the frequency-domain signal to reduce noise in the frequency-domain signal. The embodiments also identify, from within the averaged frequency-domain signal, a tone representative of the center frequency of the jamming signal and tones representative of the symbol rate of the jamming signal. The embodiments then set a frequency value of the tone representative of the center frequency and frequency values of the tones representative of the symbol rate as values forming the medium granularity estimate.

(109) The process of refining the second set of estimation parameters to generate the third set of estimation parameters is similar to the process described above. Specifically, the process involves using the second set of estimation parameters to apply the same wide filter to the input signal to

generate a third filtered signal. The width of the wide filter is set to a value of the medium granularity estimate of the symbol rate of the jamming signal plus a second wide buffer amount (e.g., perhaps between about 1-10% larger). The wide filter is centered at the medium granularity estimate of the center frequency of the jamming signal and filters signal content beyond the medium granularity estimate of the symbol rate plus the second wide buffer amount. The non-linear operator is applied to the third filtered signal to generate a second modified signal.

(110) The same narrow filter is applied to the second modified signal to generate a fourth filtered signal. The width of the narrow filter is set to a value of the medium granularity estimate of the symbol rate of the jamming signal plus a second narrow buffer amount (e.g., perhaps between about 1-10% larger), and the narrow filter is centered at the medium granularity estimate of the center frequency of the jamming signal.

(111) The Fast Fourier Transform (FFT) is applied to the fourth filtered signal to generate a second frequency-domain signal. The averaging function is applied to the second frequency-domain signal to smooth out the second frequency-domain signal to reduce noise in the second frequency-domain signal. The embodiments then identify, from within the averaged second frequency-domain signal, a fine granularity tone representative of the center frequency of the jamming signal and fine granularity tones representative of the symbol rate of the jamming signal. The embodiments also set a fine granularity frequency value of the fine granularity tone representative of the center frequency and fine granularity frequency values of the fine granularity tones representative of the symbol rate as values forming the fine granularity estimate.

(112) Attention will now be returned to FIG. 18B. Specifically, after the third set of estimation parameters are generated, method 1800 includes an act (act 1825) of using the third set of estimation parameters to remove or reduce an influence of the jamming signal on the input signal such that the SOI is identified. Removing or reducing the influence of the jamming signal results in up to and potentially even beyond about a 25 dB reduction in signal strength of the jamming signal. The removal component 1935 from FIG. 19 performs such operations to produce the SOI 1940. FIGS. 26 and 27 provide additional detail regarding the removal operations.

(113) FIG. 26 shows an example process 2600 for using the third set of estimation parameters (i.e. the fine granularity parameters mentioned earlier) to remove or reduce the influence of the jamming signal on the input signal such that the SOI is identified. Initially, process 2600 includes an act (act 2605) of feeding the third set of estimation parameters as input parameters to a demod-remod circuit (i.e. a demodulation-remodulation circuit). In parallel or in series with act 2605 is act 2610, which involves feeding the input signal to the demod-remod circuit.

(114) Act 2615 then includes causing the demod-remod circuit to demodulate the input signal using the third set of estimation parameters to obtain an estimated sequence representative of the jamming signal. Subsequently, act 2620 includes causing the demod-remod circuit to remodulate the estimated sequence such that the estimated sequence is reshaped into a replica of the jamming signal. Finally, act 2625 includes subtracting the replica of the jamming signal from the input signal to obtain the SOI. FIG. 27 provides a helpful illustration of this process.

(115) FIG. 27 shows an example architecture of a removal component 2700, which is representative of the removal component 1935 from FIG. 19 and which is configured to perform act 1825 described earlier. An input signal 2705, which is representative of the input signals mentioned throughout this disclosure, and a set of fine granularity parameters 2710, which are representative of those mentioned throughout, are fed as input into one or more demod-remod circuits, such as demod-remod circuits 2715, 2720, 2725, and 2730. The ellipsis 2735 shows how any number of demod-remod circuits may be used. Accordingly, removing or reducing the influence of the jamming signal on the input signal includes use of one or more demod-remod circuits. Inasmuch as demod-remod circuits are generally known in the art, a specific description of their architectures and operations will not be provided herein. Notably, a number of demod-remod circuits that are used may be dependent on a number of jamming signals that are included in the

composite signal. Further details will be provided momentarily.

(116) Often, the jamming signal with the highest power is operated on first. In some cases, once the highest powered jamming signal is removed, then the next highest powered jamming signal is operated on and is removed, and so on and so forth.

(117) An input signal, which is a composite signal comprising a SOI and a jamming signal, may actually include more than one jamming signal. Indeed, the composite signal may include 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, or more than 10 jamming signals. The number of demod-remod circuits that are employed or activated is based on the number of jamming signals. As will be described in more detail later, a feedback loop is provided in the removal component **2700** to enable the elimination of multiple different jamming signals.

(118) In any event, a demod-remod circuit receives the input signal **2705** and the fine granularity parameters **2710**. The circuit demodulates the input signal using the fine granularity parameters **2710** to obtain an estimated sequence that is representative of the jamming signal. The circuit then remodulates the estimated sequence in a manner so that it is reshaped into a replica of the jamming signal. The removal component **2700** then subtracts (as shown by subtract **2740**) the replica of the jamming signal from a delayed version (as shown by delay **2745**) of the input signal **2705** to thereby remove, eliminate, or at least reduce an impact of the jamming signal from the input signal **2705** to produce the SOI **2755**. The removal component **2700** includes a feedback loop **2750** to enable multiple iterations in the event that multiple jamming signals are present in the input signal **2705**.

(119) By following the disclosed operations, the embodiments are beneficially able to remove or reduce the impact of a jamming signal on a SOI. Such operations can be performed essentially in real-time and can be performed to remove multiple jamming signals. The disclosed embodiments are highly efficient and less compute-intensive than traditional systems.

(120) Accordingly, the disclosed embodiments describe a multi-stage process for iteratively inferring or estimating parameters of a jamming signal. These parameters are then used by a demod-remod circuit in order to lock on to the jamming signal and to enable that jamming signal to be removed or subtracted from the input signal to produce the SOI. In some cases, the phase locked loops of the demod-remod circuits might temporarily lose the lock on the signal. In such cases, the system can re-lock onto the input signal as a result of performing continuous or near-continuous monitoring of the input signal. Therefore, even if the input signal is lost for a brief period of time, the embodiments are able to re-lock onto the signal by continuously (e.g., in real-time or near real-time) monitoring the signal.

Example Computer/Computer Systems

(121) Attention will now be directed to FIG. **28** which illustrates an example computer system **28** that may include and/or be used to perform any of the operations described herein. To further clarify, the computer system **2800** can be configured to perform the operations discussed in the various figures and methods. Computer system **2800** may take various different forms. For example, computer system **2800** may be embodied as a tablet **2800A**, a desktop or laptop **2800B**, a wearable device **2800C**, a mobile device, or a standalone device. The ellipsis **2800D** shows how any configuration may be used. Computer system **2800** may also be a distributed system that includes one or more connected computing components/devices that are in communication with computer system **2800**.

(122) In its most basic configuration, computer system **2800** includes various different components. FIG. **28** shows that computer system **2800** includes one or more processor(s) **2805** (aka a “hardware processing unit”) and storage **2810**.

(123) Regarding the processor(s) **2805**, it will be appreciated that the functionality described herein can be performed, at least in part, by one or more hardware logic components (e.g., the processor(s) **2805**). For example, and without limitation, illustrative types of hardware logic components/processors that can be used include Field-Programmable Gate Arrays (“FPGA”),

Program-Specific or Application-Specific Integrated Circuits (“ASIC”), Program-Specific Standard Products (“ASSP”), System-On-A-Chip Systems (“SOC”), Complex Programmable Logic Devices (“CPLD”), Central Processing Units (“CPU”), Graphical Processing Units (“GPU”), or any other type of programmable hardware.

(124) As used herein, terms such as “executable module,” “executable component,” “component,” “module,” “engine”, or perhaps even “circuit” can refer to hardware processing units or to software objects, routines, or methods that may be executed on computer system **2800**. The different components, modules, engines, and services described herein may be implemented as objects or processors that execute on computer system **2800** (e.g. as separate threads).

(125) Storage **2810** may be physical system memory, which may be volatile, non-volatile, or some combination of the two. The term “memory” may also be used herein to refer to non-volatile mass storage such as physical storage media. If computer system **2800** is distributed, the processing, memory, and/or storage capability may be distributed as well.

(126) Storage **2810** is shown as including executable instructions **2815**. The executable instructions **2815** represent instructions that are executable by the processor(s) **2805** of computer system **2800** to perform the disclosed operations, such as those described in the various methods.

(127) The disclosed embodiments may comprise or utilize a special-purpose or general-purpose computer including computer hardware, such as, for example, one or more processors (such as processor(s) **2805**) and system memory (such as storage **2810**), as discussed in greater detail below. Embodiments also include physical and other computer-readable media for carrying or storing computer-executable instructions and/or data structures. Such computer-readable media can be any available media that can be accessed by a general-purpose or special-purpose computer system. Computer-readable media that store computer-executable instructions in the form of data are “physical computer storage media” or a “hardware storage device.” Computer-readable media that carry computer-executable instructions are “transmission media.” Thus, by way of example and not limitation, the current embodiments can comprise at least two distinctly different kinds of computer-readable media: computer storage media and transmission media.

(128) Computer storage media (aka “hardware storage device”) are computer-readable hardware storage devices, such as RAM, ROM, EEPROM, CD-ROM, solid state drives (“SSD”) that are based on RAM, Flash memory, phase-change memory (“PCM”), or other types of memory, or other optical disk storage, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium that can be used to store desired program code means in the form of computer-executable instructions, data, or data structures and that can be accessed by a general-purpose or special-purpose computer.

(129) Computer system **2800** may also be connected (via a wired or wireless connection) to external sensors (e.g., one or more remote cameras) or devices via a network **2820**. For example, computer system **2800** can communicate with any number devices or cloud services to obtain or process data. In some cases, network **2820** may itself be a cloud network. Furthermore, computer system **2800** may also be connected through one or more wired or wireless networks **2820** to remote/separate computer systems(s) that are configured to perform any of the processing described with regard to computer system **2800**.

(130) A “network,” like network **2820**, is defined as one or more data links and/or data switches that enable the transport of electronic data between computer systems, modules, and/or other electronic devices. When information is transferred, or provided, over a network (either hardwired, wireless, or a combination of hardwired and wireless) to a computer, the computer properly views the connection as a transmission medium. Computer system **2800** will include one or more communication channels that are used to communicate with the network **2820**. Transmissions media include a network that can be used to carry data or desired program code means in the form of computer-executable instructions or in the form of data structures. Further, these computer-executable instructions can be accessed by a general-purpose or special-purpose computer.

Combinations of the above should also be included within the scope of computer-readable media. (131) Upon reaching various computer system components, program code means in the form of computer-executable instructions or data structures can be transferred automatically from transmission media to computer storage media (or vice versa). For example, computer-executable instructions or data structures received over a network or data link can be buffered in RAM within a network interface module (e.g., a network interface card or “NIC”) and then eventually transferred to computer system RAM and/or to less volatile computer storage media at a computer system. Thus, it should be understood that computer storage media can be included in computer system components that also (or even primarily) utilize transmission media.

(132) Computer-executable (or computer-interpretable) instructions comprise, for example, instructions that cause a general-purpose computer, special-purpose computer, or special-purpose processing device to perform a certain function or group of functions. The computer-executable instructions may be, for example, binaries, intermediate format instructions such as assembly language, or even source code. Although the subject matter has been described in language specific to structural features and/or methodological acts, it is to be understood that the subject matter defined in the appended claims is not necessarily limited to the described features or acts described above. Rather, the described features and acts are disclosed as example forms of implementing the claims.

(133) Those skilled in the art will appreciate that the embodiments may be practiced in network computing environments with many types of computer system configurations, including personal computers, desktop computers, laptop computers, message processors, hand-held devices, multi-processor systems, microprocessor-based or programmable consumer electronics, network PCs, minicomputers, mainframe computers, mobile telephones, PDAs, pagers, routers, switches, and the like. The embodiments may also be practiced in distributed system environments where local and remote computer systems that are linked (either by hardwired data links, wireless data links, or by a combination of hardwired and wireless data links) through a network each perform tasks (e.g. cloud computing, cloud services and the like). In a distributed system environment, program modules may be located in both local and remote memory storage devices.

(134) The present invention may be embodied in other specific forms without departing from its characteristics. The described embodiments are to be considered in all respects only as illustrative and not restrictive. The scope of the invention is, therefore, indicated by the appended claims rather than by the foregoing description. All changes which come within the meaning and range of equivalency of the claims are to be embraced within their scope.

Claims

1. A method for inferring coarse information regarding aspects of an interfering signal to thereby lead to improved detection and parameter estimation, said method comprising: identifying an input signal that is suspected of being a jammed composite signal comprising a combination of a signal of interest (SOI) and a jamming signal; determining attributes of a reference signal, said attributes including a center frequency of the reference signal and a symbol rate of the reference signal, said reference signal being an expected signal that was expected to be received in lieu of the input signal; performing a form fitting operation in which the reference signal is form fitted with the input signal to obtain a best fit alignment between the reference signal and the input signal; subtracting the reference signal from the input signal to generate an isolated output signal; identifying a suspected portion of the isolated output signal where the jamming signal is likely to be occurring; determining a symbol rate of the suspected portion and a center frequency of the suspected portion; setting the symbol rate of the suspected portion as an estimated symbol rate of the jamming signal and setting the center frequency of the suspected portion as an estimated center frequency of the jamming signal; and using the estimated symbol rate of the jamming signal and

the estimated center frequency of the jamming signal to facilitate elimination or reduction of an impact of the jamming signal against the SOI.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein the determined attributes of the reference signal further include a type of signal that the reference signal is.

3. The method of claim 1, wherein the determined attributes of the reference signal further include an alpha value of the reference signal, said alpha value reflecting a waveform narrowness of the reference signal.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein the estimated symbol rate of the jamming symbol is within a first range between about 500 kilohertz and about 700 kilohertz of an actual symbol rate of the jamming signal.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein the estimated center frequency is within a second range between about 500 kilohertz and about 700 kilohertz of an actual center frequency of the jamming signal.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein subtracting the reference signal from the input signal to generate the isolated output signal includes: determining an average relative power of the input signal; based on the average relative power of the input signal, determining that an estimated average relative power of the reference signal is a threshold amount below the average relative power of the input signal; and subtracting the reference signal, including the estimated average relative power of the reference signal, from the input signal, including the average relative power of the input signal, to generate the isolated output signal.

7. The method of claim 6, wherein the threshold amount is between about 3 dB to 5 dB such that the estimated average relative power of the reference signal is between about 3 dB to 5 dB below the average relative power of the input signal.

8. The method of claim 1, wherein identifying the suspected portion of the isolated output signal includes: performing a second form fitting operation in which a parabolic equation is form fitted to the suspected portion of the isolated output signal; identifying a localized peak of the parabolic equation; and identifying a first roll off of a first side of the parabolic equation and a second roll off of a second side of the parabolic equation.

9. The method of claim 8, wherein the symbol rate of the suspected portion is determined based on the first roll off and the second roll off.

10. The method of claim 9, wherein the center frequency of the suspected portion is determined based on a center frequency value of the parabolic equation between the first roll off and the second roll off.

11. A computer system configured to infer coarse information regarding aspects of an interfering signal to thereby lead to improved detection and parameter estimation, said computer system comprising: one or more processors; and one or more computer-readable hardware storage devices that store instructions that are executable by the one or more processors to cause the computer system to at least: identify an input signal that is suspected of being a jammed composite signal comprising a combination of a signal of interest (SOI) and a jamming signal; determine attributes of a reference signal, said attributes including a center frequency of the reference signal and a symbol rate of the reference signal, said reference signal being an expected signal that was expected to be received in lieu of the input signal; perform a form fitting operation in which the reference signal is form fitted with the input signal to obtain a best fit alignment between the reference signal and the input signal; subtract the reference signal from the input signal to generate an isolated output signal; identify a suspected portion of the isolated output signal where the jamming signal is likely to be occurring; determine a symbol rate of the suspected portion and a center frequency of the suspected portion; set the symbol rate of the suspected portion as an estimated symbol rate of the jamming signal and setting the center frequency of the suspected portion as an estimated center frequency of the jamming signal; and use the estimated symbol rate of the jamming signal and the estimated center frequency of the jamming signal to facilitate elimination or reduction of an impact of the jamming signal against the SOI.

12. The computer system of claim 11, wherein a machine learning (ML) algorithm identifies the suspected portion of the isolated output signal, and wherein the ML algorithm is implemented using one of: a neural network comprising one of a convolutional neural network, a multilayer neural network, a recursive neural network, or a deep neural network; a decision tree model comprising one of a decision tree, a random forest, or a gradient boosted tree; a linear regression model; or a support vector machine.

13. The computer system of claim 11, wherein identifying the suspected portion of the isolated output signal where the jamming signal is likely to be occurring includes identifying a distinct hump in the isolated output signal.

14. The computer system of claim 11, wherein the attributes of the reference signal are determined prior in time to a time when the input signal is received.

15. The computer system of claim 11, wherein the estimated center frequency is within a second range between about 400 kilohertz and about 800 kilohertz of an actual center frequency of the jamming signal.

16. The computer system of claim 11, wherein performing the form fitting operation in which the reference signal is form fitted with the input signal includes selecting at least a set of points along a waveform representative of the reference signal and aligning the at least the set of points with corresponding points of a waveform representative of the input signal.

17. The computer system of claim 16, wherein the threshold amount is between about 2 dB to 6 dB such that the estimated average relative power of the reference signal is between about 2 dB to 6 dB below the average relative power of the input signal.

18. The computer system of claim 11, wherein performing the form fitting operation in which the reference signal is form fitted with the input signal includes aligning a threshold number of points of a waveform representative of the reference signal with a corresponding number of points of a waveform representative of the input signal.

19. A computer system configured to infer coarse information regarding aspects of an interfering signal to thereby lead to improved detection and parameter estimation, said computer system comprising: one or more processors; and one or more computer-readable hardware storage devices that store instructions that are executable by the one or more processors to cause the computer system to at least: identify an input signal that is suspected of being a jammed composite signal comprising a combination of a signal of interest (SOI) and a jamming signal; determine attributes of a reference signal, said attributes including a center frequency of the reference signal and a symbol rate of the reference signal, said reference signal being an expected signal that was expected to be received in lieu of the input signal; perform a form fitting operation in which the reference signal is form fitted with the input signal to obtain a best fit alignment between the reference signal and the input signal; subtract the reference signal from the input signal to generate an isolated output signal, wherein subtracting the reference signal from the input signal to generate the isolated output signal includes: determining an average relative power of the input signal; based on the average relative power of the input signal, determining that an estimated average relative power of the reference signal is a threshold amount below the average relative power of the input signal; and subtracting the reference signal, including the estimated average relative power of the reference signal, from the input signal, including the average relative power of the input signal, to generate the isolated output signal; identify a suspected portion of the isolated output signal where the jamming signal is likely to be occurring; determine a symbol rate of the suspected portion and a center frequency of the suspected portion; set the symbol rate of the suspected portion as an estimated symbol rate of the jamming signal and setting the center frequency of the suspected portion as an estimated center frequency of the jamming signal; and use the estimated symbol rate of the jamming signal and the estimated center frequency of the jamming signal to facilitate elimination or reduction of an impact of the jamming signal against the SOI.

20. The computer system of claim 19, wherein performing the form fitting operation in which the

reference signal is form fitted with the input signal includes aligning the reference signal with the input signal so that a level of overlap between the reference signal and the input signal satisfies an overlap requirement.
